User Stories and Acceptance Criteria

Member Premium Payment Portal

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Portfolio sample. Northwind Health Plan is a fictional company, and all data, rules, and figures are invented for illustration.

How to Read This Document

Each story follows the format **As a [role], I want [goal], so that [benefit]**. Acceptance criteria are written in Given / When / Then form so developers can build to them and QA can test them directly. Each story shows the business requirement it supports.

US-01: View premium due

Supports: BR-01 | **Priority:** High | **Estimate:** 3 points

As a member, **I want** to see my current premium amount, due date, and grace period status, **so that** I know exactly what I owe and when.

Acceptance Criteria

- **AC-01.1:** Given I am logged in, when I open the payment page, then I see my premium amount, due date, and account status.
- **AC-01.2:** Given my due date has passed and I am within the 30-day grace period, when I open the payment page, then I see a grace period notice with the last day to pay.
- **AC-01.3:** Given I have already paid for the current period, when I open the payment page, then I see "Paid" with the payment date and no pay button.

US-02: Pay premium online

Supports: BR-02 | **Priority:** High | **Estimate:** 5 points

As a member, **I want** to pay my premium online by bank account or card, **so that** I can pay quickly without mailing a check or calling.

Acceptance Criteria

- **AC-02.1:** Given I am on the payment page, when I choose ACH or card and enter valid details, then I can review and submit the payment.
- **AC-02.2:** Given I enter invalid details (for example, a wrong routing number), when I submit, then I see a clear error message and no payment is sent.

- **AC-02.3:** Given my payment is confirmed, when the process finishes, then I see a confirmation number on screen.

US-03: Validate payment amount

Supports: BR-03 | **Priority:** High | **Estimate:** 5 points

As a billing specialist, **I want** payments that do not match the billed amount to be flagged before posting, **so that** accounts are not posted incorrectly.

Acceptance Criteria

- **AC-03.1:** Given a payment equals the billed amount, when it is submitted, then it moves on to the payment gateway.
- **AC-03.2:** Given a payment is higher or lower than the billed amount, when it is submitted, then it is not posted automatically and is placed in the exception queue with the reason "Amount mismatch".
- **AC-03.3:** Given a payment is placed in the exception queue, when the member views the portal, then they see a message that the payment is under review.

US-04: Post payment to the account

Supports: BR-04 | **Priority:** High | **Estimate:** 5 points

As a member, **I want** my confirmed payment to appear on my account right away, **so that** I know my coverage is safe.

Acceptance Criteria

- **AC-04.1:** Given the gateway confirms a payment, when processing completes, then the payment is posted to my account within 2 minutes.
- **AC-04.2:** Given the payment is posted, when I view my account, then the balance shows as paid for the current period.
- **AC-04.3:** Given posting takes longer than 2 minutes, when the time limit passes, then the payment is flagged in the exception queue with the reason "Posting delay".
- **AC-04.4:** Given a payment is posted, when I check my email, then I receive a confirmation with the amount, date, and confirmation number.

US-05: Block duplicate payments

Supports: BR-05 | **Priority:** High | **Estimate:** 3 points

As a billing manager, **I want** duplicate payments for the same period to be blocked, **so that** we avoid refunds and corrections.

Acceptance Criteria

- **AC-05.1:** Given a successful payment exists for the current period, when the member tries to pay again, then the system blocks it and shows "A payment has already been received for this period."
- **AC-05.2:** Given a payment is still being processed, when the member submits another one, then the system blocks it until the first payment completes or fails.
- **AC-05.3:** Given a duplicate is blocked, when I review the audit log, then the blocked attempt is recorded.

US-06: Handle failed payments

Supports: BR-06 | **Priority:** Medium | **Estimate:** 3 points

As a member, **I want** to be told when my payment fails and be able to try again, **so that** I do not lose coverage by mistake.

Acceptance Criteria

- **AC-06.1:** Given the gateway declines a payment, when the result returns, then I see the reason in plain language and an option to retry.
- **AC-06.2:** Given a payment fails, when the result returns, then I receive an email notification.
- **AC-06.3:** Given I have made 3 failed attempts in 24 hours, when I try again, then I see a message to contact Customer Service.

US-07: Work the exception queue

Supports: BR-07 | **Priority:** High | **Estimate:** 5 points

As a billing specialist, **I want** a queue of held payments with the reason for each, **so that** I can review and resolve them quickly.

Acceptance Criteria

- **AC-07.1:** Given payments are on hold, when I open the queue, then I see member ID, amount, billed amount, reason, and date for each item.
- **AC-07.2:** Given I open an item, when I choose Approve, Adjust, or Reject, then the action is saved and the member account is updated accordingly.
- **AC-07.3:** Given I complete any action, when I check the audit log, then my user ID, the action, and the date and time are recorded.

US-08: Monitor payment performance

Supports: BR-08 | **Priority:** Medium | **Estimate:** 3 points

As a billing manager, **I want** a dashboard of payment status and exceptions, **so that** I can spot problems early.

Acceptance Criteria

- **AC-08.1:** Given I open the dashboard, when it loads, then I see total payments, successful payments, failed payments, and open exceptions for the selected period.
- **AC-08.2:** Given I select a date range, when I apply it, then all figures update for that range.
- **AC-08.3:** Given I view the dashboard, when I check the posting time, then I see the percentage of payments posted within 2 minutes.

Definition of Done

- Code is complete and peer reviewed.
- All acceptance criteria are tested and passed by QA.
- Business owner has accepted the story in the sprint review.
- The story is linked to its requirement and test cases in the RTM.
- No open critical or high defects.